

# MSC ELSA 3 — floating debris & pellet drift

As of 6 Jun, 04:00 IST · Prepared by DriftSight · prototype

**Summary.** 7 satellite passes processed since the sinking on 25 May 2025 (4 usable, 3 clouded). DriftSight has flagged 10 candidate debris patches; 2 are confirmed because they re-appeared where the currents predicted, and 2 look-alikes were rejected before any boat was sent. The pellet forecast puts 88% of the simulated nurdles ashore by this time.

|                          |                      |                           |                     |
|--------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------|---------------------|
| 2                        | 2                    | 88%                       | 1                   |
| confirmed debris patches | look-alikes rejected | pellets ashore (forecast) | high-priority zones |

## TRACKED PATCHES

| Patch   | First seen        | Area     | Confidence | Status    |
|---------|-------------------|----------|------------|-----------|
| Patch A | 27 May, 11:00 IST | 3,300 m² | 99%        | confirmed |
| Patch B | 27 May, 11:00 IST | 300 m²   | 15%        | rejected  |
| Patch C | 27 May, 11:00 IST | 3,200 m² | 96%        | confirmed |
| Patch D | 30 May, 11:00 IST | 400 m²   | 23%        | rejected  |

## PELLET LANDFALL OUTLOOK

Thiruvananthapuram 70% (first 27 May) · Kanyakumari 16% (first 29 May) · Kollam 2% (first 27 May) · Ramanathapuram 0% (first 7 Jun). Forecast first arrival at Kanyakumari 29 May, 04:00 IST, consistent with the 30 May beach survey that rated pellet pollution “Very High”.

## PRIORITY ACTIONS

- HIGH** — Patch A (at sea) (9.001°N 79.281°E): Boat verification, then boom / skimmer recovery if confirmed. Nearest harbour Pamban.
- MEDIUM** — Patch C (at sea) (8.543°N 78.593°E): Boat verification, then boom / skimmer recovery if confirmed. Nearest harbour Thoothukudi.

## MISSIONS

No missions created yet.

## DATA & METHOD

Detection: per-pixel classifier on Sentinel-2 bands with FDI/NDVI. Tracking: ensemble particle drift with Bayesian confirmation at each pass. Prototype uses synthetic imagery and a synthetic monsoon circulation; production uses Sentinel-2/Landsat/Sentinel-1, INCOIS/CMEMS currents and ERA5 winds.

Prototype. Detection imagery and ocean fields in this report are simulated; no figure here is a measurement. Production sources: Sentinel-2 / Landsat / Sentinel-1 imagery, INCOIS and CMEMS currents, ERA5 winds.